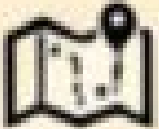
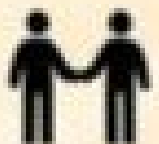
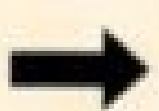


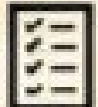
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Introduction

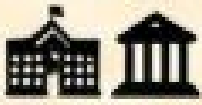
-  One of the most significant events in the history of the Subcontinent.
-  The decision was primarily driven by administrative necessity.
-  Initiated by the British Viceroy, Lord Curzon.
-  The partition divided the massive Bengal Presidency into two parts.
-  It marked the beginning of a formal political rift between Hindus and Muslims.
-  The period (1905–1911) shaped the future of the Pakistan Movement.
-  It highlighted the British 'Divide and Rule' strategy.

Bengal Before Partition

-  Bengal was the largest province of British India.
-  Included modern-day West Bengal, Bangladesh, Bihar, and Odisha.
-  The total area covered roughly 189,000 square miles.
-  The population was approximately 78 to 80 million people.
-  The administration was centralized in Calcutta (now Kolkata).
-  Eastern regions were largely neglected by the central government.
-  Communication and transportation were extremely difficult across such a vast area.

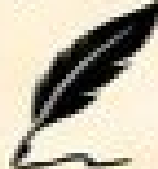
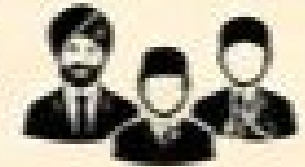
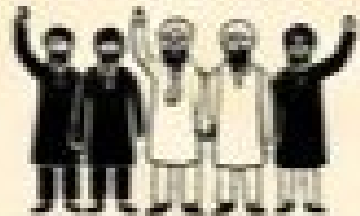


Administrative Challenges

-  A single Lieutenant Governor could not manage the entire population.
-  Law and order situations were difficult to monitor in remote areas.
-  Revenue collection was inefficient due to the distance from the capital.
-  Eastern districts suffered from a lack of educational and judicial infrastructure.
-  Officials struggled with the diverse linguistic and cultural landscape.
-  Local governance was nearly non-existent in the rural East.
- “ Lord Curzon described the province as ‘unwieldy and unmanageable.’ ”

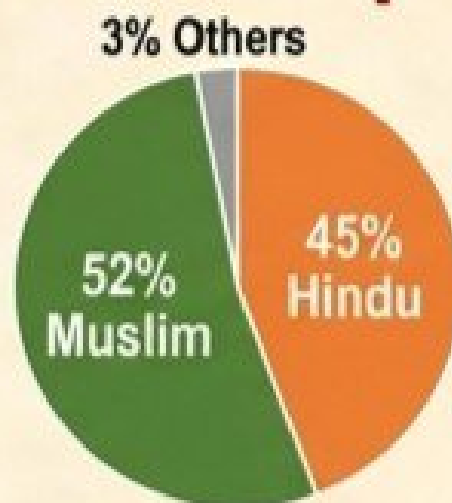


Political Situation

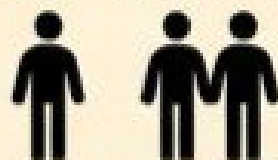
-  Calcutta was the center of Indian political consciousness. 
-  The Indian National Congress (founded 1885) was gaining strength. 
-  The British sought to weaken the influence of the Bengali intelligentsia. 
-  Nationalist sentiments were rising against British colonial rule. 
-  Bengali leaders advocated for 'Swaraj' (Self-rule). 
-  The British government wanted to create a loyalist block in the East. 
-  Political agitation was primarily led by the Hindu elite. 

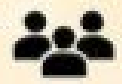
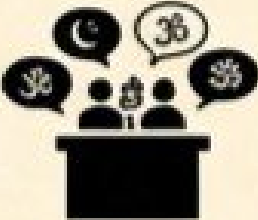
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Religious Composition

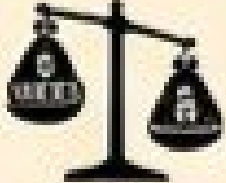


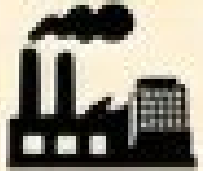
-  Bengal was roughly divided by religious majorities. 
-  Eastern Bengal had a significant Muslim majority. 
-  Western Bengal (including Bihar/Odisha) was Hindu-dominated.
-  Western Bengal (including Bihar/Odisha) was Hindu-dominated.
-  Muslims in the East were mostly peasant farmers and laborers.
-  Hindus in the West held the majority of land and government posts. 
-  Total population: ~42 million Hindus and ~31 million Muslims.



-  Total population: ~42 million Hindus and ~31 million Muslims.
- Religious identity became a central factor in the partition debate. 

Economic Conditions

- 

Economic disparity was high between the East and the West.
- 

Industry and trade were concentrated in Calcutta.
- 

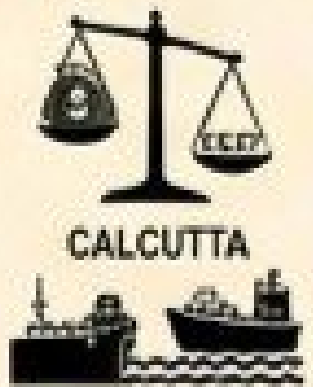
Raw materials (jute/rice) were produced in the East but processed in the West.
- 

The East lacked its own major port facility for direct trade.
- 

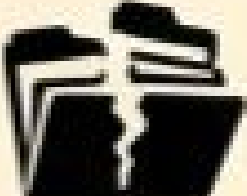
Muslims were economically suppressed by the Hindu 'Zamindari' system.
- 

Educational institutions were scarce in the Eastern districts.
- 

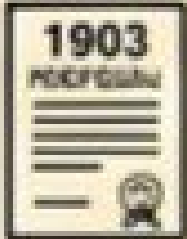
Partition promised a shift of economic focus toward the East.



Reasons for Partition

-  Administrative: To ease the burden on the Lieutenant Governor. 
-  Geographic: To improve governance in the far-flung Eastern regions. 
-  Economic: To develop the Port of Chittagong. 
-  Educational: To establish better schools and colleges in the East.
-  Political: To curb the rising nationalist influence in Calcutta.
-  Social: To provide the Muslim majority with a voice in governance. 
-  Strategic: To ensure better law and order near the borders.

Announcement of Partition (1905)

-  Formal proposal made by Lord Curzon in 1903.
 
- Final decision officially announced on July 19, 1905.
 
- The date was observed as a 'Day of Mourning' by Hindu nationalists.
- The announcement was met with immediate and divided reactions.

1905

- The partition took legal effect on October 16, 1905.
 
- The date was observed as a 'Day of Mourning' by Hindu nationalists.
- Lord Curzon defended it as a purely administrative reform.
 

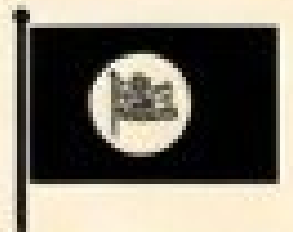
- British officials ignored the initial wave of local protests.
 

New Provinces

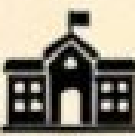
Province	Regions Included	Capital	Majority
West Bengal	West Bengal, Bihar, Odisha	Calcutta	Hindu
East Bengal & Assam	East Bengal, Assam, Sylhet	Dhaka	Muslim

-  Dhaka was restored to its former glory as a capital city.
-  The new province of East Bengal had a population of 31 million.
-  The division created a new administrative identity for Muslims.

New
8 million

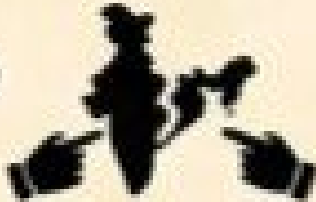
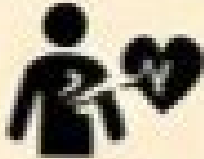
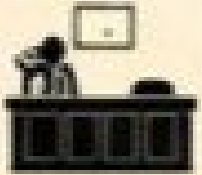
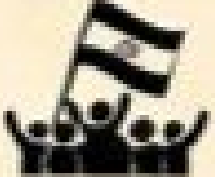


Benefits for Muslims

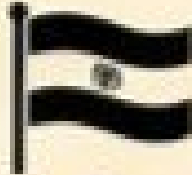
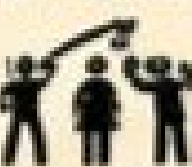
-  The East Bengal province gave Muslims a clear majority.
-  Dhaka became a center for political and social development.
-  Muslims gained better access to government jobs and services.
-  Improved educational opportunities led to the rise of Muslim middle class. 
-  The Port of Chittagong increased trade prospects for Muslim merchants.
-  Freedom from the economic dominance of the Calcutta-based elite.
-  Enhanced political representation within the British administrative framework.

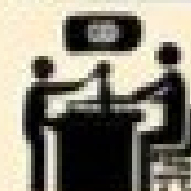
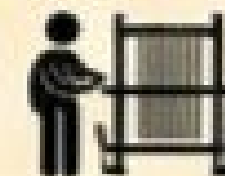
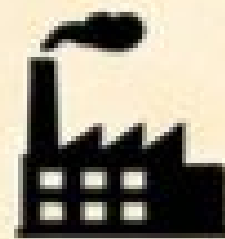


Hindu Reaction

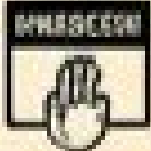
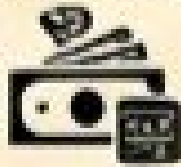
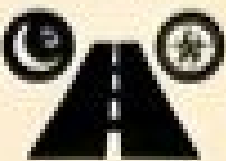
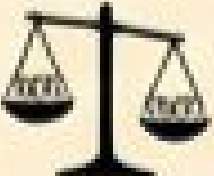
-  Hindus labeled the partition as 'Divide and Rule.' 
-  They viewed it as an attempt to 'vivisect' the Bengali motherland.
-  Hindu lawyers feared loss of practice to new courts in Dhaka. 
-  Businessmen in Calcutta feared economic competition from Chittagong.
-  The Indian National Congress launched a nationwide protest.
-  Radical leaders like Tilak and Lajpat Rai called for aggressive action. 
-  The move was seen as a deliberate blow to Indian nationalism.

Swadeshi Movement

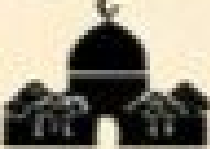
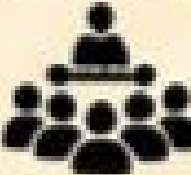
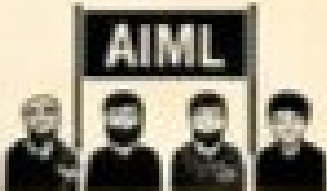
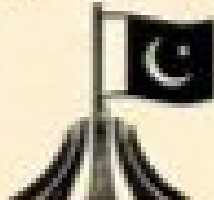
-  The primary method of protest against the 1905 partition.
-  A complete boycott of British-made goods (especially cloth).
-  Public bonfires were made of foreign textiles and products.
-  Promotion of local 'Swadeshi' (indigenous) industries.
-  Use of the slogan 'Vande Mataram' as a rallying cry.
-  The movement turned violent in several urban areas for aggressive action.
-  It caused a significant drop in British textile imports from Manchester.



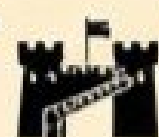
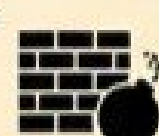
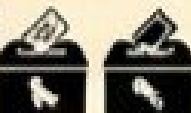
Muslim Support for Partition

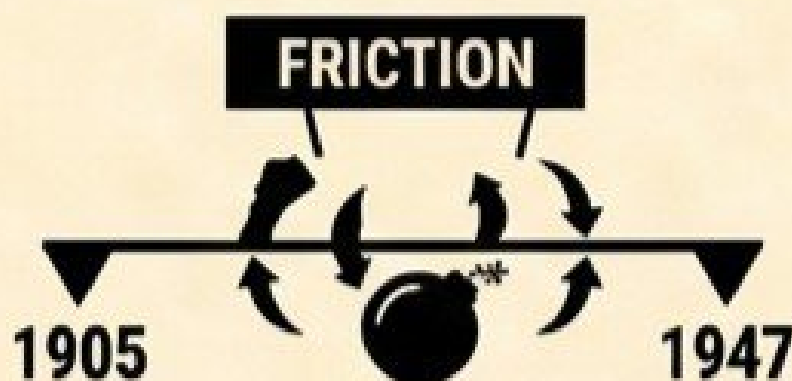
-  Muslim leaders, led by Nawab Salimullah Khan, welcomed the move. 
-  Aga Khan III supported the administrative division.
-   Muslims saw the Swadeshi movement as an attempt to maintain Hindu hegemony.
-  Large meetings were held in Dhaka to express gratitude to the British.
-  Muslims recognized that the partition secured their socio-economic future.
-  This support solidified the distinct political path of the Muslims.
-  It highlighted that Muslim and Hindu interests were not always aligned.

Formation of Muslim League (1906)

-  Direct result of the political climate after the Partition of Bengal. 
-  Founded on December 30, 1906, in Dhaka. 
-  Key Founder: Nawab Salimullah Khan of Dhaka.
-  Primary Objective: To protect Muslim rights and interests.
-  To counter the anti-partition propaganda of the Congress. 
-  The League became the representative body for Indian Muslims. 
-  It marked the formal beginning of the organized Pakistan Movement. 

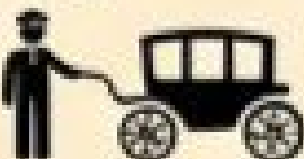
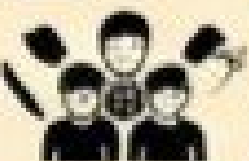
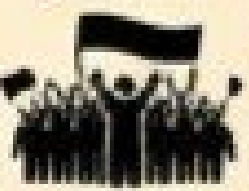
British Divide and Rule Policy

- 
 Historians often analyze if the move was purely administrative.
- 
 Critics argue the British intentionally sparked communal rivalry.
 
- 
 The policy aimed to prevent a united front against colonial rule.
 
- 
 By favoring Muslims in the East, the British balanced Hindu power.
 
- 
 It created a 'buffer' against the revolutionary movements in Calcutta.
 
- 
 This strategy eventually led to the demand for Separate Electorates.
 
- The friction created during this era persisted until 1947.



Protest Against Partition

- 
 Protests escalated between 1907 and 1910. 

 1907 —————> 1907 —————> 1910
- 
 Extremist leaders like Bipin Chandra Pal advocated for 'Purna Swaraj'. 
- 
 There were assassination attempts on British officials. 
- 
 The 'Anushilan Samiti' used revolutionary violence against the state. 
- 
 Massive rallies and strikes paralyzed the administration in West Bengal. 
- 
 British businesses faced severe financial losses due to the boycott. 
- 
 The intensity of the unrest pressured the British government to reconsider. 

Annulment of Partition (1911)

Jan 1911
(George V
accession)

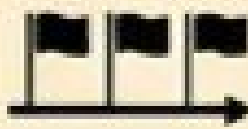
Jun 1911
(King's resolve)

Dec 12 1911
(DELHI DURBAR)

-  Announced by King George V during the Delhi Durbar.
-  Date of Annulment: December 12, 1911.
-  The two Bengals were reunited into a single province.
-  To compensate, the capital of India was moved from Calcutta to Delhi.
-  Bihar and Odisha were separated into distinct provinces.
-  The annulment proved that the British could be pressured by agitation.



Conclusion

- 
 The Partition of Bengal was a turning point in Subcontinental history.
- 
 It exposed the deep-rooted communal and political divisions.
- 
 The Muslim League's birth ensured a separate platform for Muslims.
- 
 The British lost the unconditional trust of the Muslim community.
- 
 It laid the psychological and political foundation for the Two-Nation Theory.
- 
 Events of 1905–1911 eventually led to the 1947 partition.
- 
Timeline Recap:
 1905 (Partition) → 1906 (ML formed) → 1911 (Annulment)

